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Sequential action device and solid-state starter and solid-state circuit breaker including thereof

Abstract

The present disclosure relates to an electromechanical sequential action device that is capable of sequentially interlocking a mechanical switch and a power electronic switch, where through an action sequence control, the electromechanical mechanism turns on the power electronic switch only after the mechanical switch is closed, and through an advanced travel control, turns off the power electronic switch before opening the mechanical switch, avoiding the problem of arc discharge during closing and opening of the mechanical switch, and improving the service life and connection reliability of the mechanical switch.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims the benefit of priority of China Utility Model Application No. 202321956055 filed Jul. 24, 2023 the content of which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present utility model relates to a solid-state starter and a solid-state circuit breaker, and in particular, to a sequential action device used for a power electronic switch and an isolating mechanical switch in a solid-state starter and a solid-state circuit breaker, and to a solid-state starter and a solid-state circuit including the sequential action device, wherein a power electronic switch and an isolating mechanical switch are connected in series in a main circuit.

BACKGROUND

(3) The opening and closing of most mechanical switches on the market are controlled by control loops. In the process of the opening and closing of the mechanical switches, arc discharge may occur in contact systems of the mechanical switches, compromising the service life of contacts and the contact reliability.

(4) In a circuit that uses a power electronic device as a switching device, the switching device is directly controlled by a control unit to control the turning off and turning on of the power electronic switch.

(5) In a circuit with a mechanical switch and a power electronic switch connected in series, the electronic switch generally turns off and turns on frequently, and the mechanical switch opens and closes under other conditions. However, as there is no sequential interlock between the mechanical switch and the electronic switch, arc discharge still occurs during the opening and closing of the mechanical switch, which reduces the life and reliability of the mechanical switch.

(6) Therefore, for a circuit with a mechanical switch and a power electronic switch connected in series, such as a solid-state starter and a solid-state circuit breaker, it is desirable for an sequential action device for the mechanical switch and the power electronic switch, thereby preventing arc discharge during the closing and opening of the mechanical switch, and improving the service life and connection reliability of the mechanical switch.

SUMMARY

(7) A sequential action device for a power electronic switch and a mechanical switch connected in series in a main circuit is disclosed. The sequential action device includes: a mechanical operating mechanism, wherein the mechanical switch is opened/closed based on a position of the mechanical operating mechanism; a power electronic switch software control circuit and a power electronic switch drive circuit that control the power electronic switch to turn on/turn off, where the power electronic switch software control circuit controls the power electronic switch drive circuit to control the power electronic switch to turn on/turn off; a triggering device configured to based on the position of the mechanical operating mechanism, sending a signal that allows for turning on/turning off to the power electronic switch software control circuit to control an action of the power electronic switch drive circuit; a detection circuit configured to detect whether the mechanical switch is closed, wherein when the detection circuit detects that the mechanical switch is closed, the detection circuit sends a signal that allows for turning on to the power electronic switch software control circuit, wherein during a power-on of the main circuit, the turning on of the power electronic switch and the closing of the mechanical switch are sequentially acted, and during a power-off of the main circuit, the turning off of the power electronic switch and the opening of the mechanical switch are sequentially acted.

(8) The triggering device further controls the turning on/turning off of the power electronic switch drive circuit.

(9) The sequential action during the power-on of the main circuit means that the mechanical switch is closed first, and then the power electronic switch is turned on. The sequential action during the power-off of the main circuit means that the power electronic switch is turned off first, and then the mechanical switch is opened.

(10) The triggering device is embodied by one of a micro switch, a grating sensor, and a Hall sensor.

(11) During a power-on, the mechanical switch is in an opened state and the triggering device is in a turned off state, based on a third position of the mechanical operating mechanism; the mechanical switch closes based on a second position of the mechanical operating mechanism, and the triggering device is in the turned off state based on the second position of the mechanical operating mechanism; the mechanical switch is in a closed state and the triggering device is in a turned on state, based on a first position of the mechanical operating mechanism.

(12) During a power-off, the mechanical switch is in a closed state and the triggering device is in a turned on state based on a first position of the mechanical operating mechanism; the mechanical switch remains in a closed state based on a second position of the mechanical operating mechanism, and the triggering device is in an turned off state based on the second position of the mechanical operating mechanism; the mechanical switch begins to open based on a third position of the mechanical operating mechanism, and the triggering device is in the turned off state based on

the third position of the mechanical operating mechanism.

(13) A solid-state starter is disclosed, which includes a sequential action device as described above.

(14) A solid-state circuit breaker is disclosed, which includes a sequential action device as described above.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) Aspects and advantages of the present disclosure will become apparent and readily understood from the following description of embodiments with reference to the accompanying drawings, where:

(2) FIG. 1 shows a schematic diagram of a sequential action device for a power electronic switch and a mechanical switch according to a first embodiment of the present utility model.

(3) FIG. 2 shows a schematic diagram of a sequential action device for a power electronic switch and a mechanical switch according to a second embodiment of the present utility model.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(4) The present utility model is described in detail below with reference to exemplary embodiments of the present utility model. However, the present utility model is not limited to the embodiments described herein, which may be implemented in many different forms. The described embodiments are intended only to make the present disclosure complete and thorough, and comprehensively convey the idea of the present utility model to those skilled in the art. The features of the described embodiments may be combined or substituted with each other, unless expressly excluded or otherwise expressed in the context.

(5) In the embodiments of the present utility model, unless otherwise expressly stated, the “connection” as used herein does not necessarily mean that “direct connection” or “direct contact”, but only electrical connectivity instead. In addition, phrases such as the “first”, “second” and so on as used herein are only used to distinguish parts. They do not indicate any priority or ordering, or whether the parameter values of the two parts are the same or different.

(6) Generally, mechanical switches on the market are opened or closed through control systems. In such opening or closing process, arc discharge may occur in contacts of the mechanical switches, compromising the service life of the mechanical switches and contact reliability of the contacts.

(7) The power electronic switches on the market are mainly used to turn on/turn off quickly, and do not have the function of isolating a circuit.

(8) If circuit isolation is required, an isolating mechanical switch needs to be connected in series to the power electronic switching module. During an opening or an closing of the isolating mechanical switch, the following steps needs to be performed.

(9) Closing: Close the isolating mechanical switch first, and then turn on the power electronic switch.

(10) Opening: Turn off the power electronic switch first, and then open the isolating mechanical switch.

(11) Incorrect operation or sequence may easily cause arc discharge of the isolating mechanical switch, compromising the service life and connection reliability, and even leading to safety hazards.

(12) The present application is applied in a scenario where the power electronic switch and the isolating mechanical switch are connected in series in a circuit, such as a circuit including a solid-state starter and a solid-state circuit breaker. Through a sequential control logic that actuates the power electronic switch and the mechanical switch sequentially, the power electronic switch can be turned on only after the mechanical switch is closed, and is turned off before the mechanical switch is opened. In this way, the arc discharge of the mechanical switch may be avoided, improving the service life and reliability of the mechanical switch, and enhancing safety.

(13) FIG. 1 shows a schematic diagram of a sequential action device for a power electronic switch and a mechanical switch according to a first embodiment of the present utility model.

(14) As shown in FIG. 1, a sequential action device for a power electronic switch **10** and a mechanical switch **20** according to the first embodiment of the present utility model includes: a triggering device **30**, a mechanical operating mechanism **40**, a detection circuit **50**, a power electronic switch software control circuit **60**, and a power electronic switch drive circuit **70**.

(15) As shown in FIG. 1, the power electronic switch **10** and the mechanical switch **20** are connected in series in a main circuit **100**. The mechanical operating mechanism **40** triggers an opening/closing action of the mechanical switch **20**. The power electronic switch software control circuit **60** controls the power electronic switch drive circuit **70** to control the power electronic switch **10** to turn on/turn off. The detection circuit **50** detects whether the mechanical switch **20** is closed.

(16) The triggering device **30** is embodied, for example, by a micro switch, a grating sensor, a Hall sensors or another sensor. The triggering device **30** is in an open/closed state, based on a position of the mechanical operating mechanism **40** that is sensed by a sensor. The triggering device **30** may be considered to play the role of a switching signal.

(17) Generally, the mechanical operating mechanism **40** has different control positions. In a first position, the mechanical operating mechanism **40** places both the mechanical switch **20** and the triggering device **30** in a closed state. In a second position, the mechanical operating mechanism **40** makes the mechanical switch **20** to close, and place the triggering device **30** in an opened state. In a third position, the mechanical operating mechanism **40** makes the mechanical switch **20** to open, and place the triggering device **30** in an opened state.

(18) According to the first embodiment of the present utility model, during a power-on of the main circuit, the power electronic switch **10** is turned on from an initial turned off state and the mechanical switch **20** is closed from an initial opened state, where the mechanical switch **20** is closed first, and then the power electronic switch **10** is turned on.

(19) During the power-on of the main circuit, the mechanical operating mechanism **40** unidirectionally changes from the third position to the second position and then to the first position.

(20) During the power-on of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the third position, both the triggering device **30** and the mechanical switch **20** are in an opened state.

(21) As the triggering device **30** is opened, the triggering device **30** sends a signal that allows for turning off to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**, and the power electronic switch software control circuit **60** sends an turning off command to the power electronic switch drive circuit **70** to maintain the power electronic switch **10** in the initial turned off state.

(22) Meanwhile, the detection circuit **50** detects that the mechanical switch **20** is opened, and the detection circuit **50** sends a signal that allows for turning off to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**. The power electronic switch software control circuit **60** sends an turning off command to the power electronic switch drive circuit **70** to maintain the power electronic switch **10** in the initial turned off state.

(23) At this time, the power electronic switch **10** is in the turned off state and the mechanical switch **20** are in the opened state.

(24) During the power-on of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the second position, the power electronic switch **10** remains in the turned off state, and the mechanical operating mechanism **40** opens the triggering device **30** and closes the mechanical switch **20**.

(25) During the power-on of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the first position, the mechanical switch **20** is already closed, and the triggering device **30** is changed into the closed state based on the first position. In other words, the mechanical switch **20** is closed before the triggering device **30** is closed.

(26) When the detection circuit **50** detects that the mechanical switch **20** is closed, the detection circuit **50** sends a signal that allows for turning on to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**.

(27) When the triggering device **30** is closed, the triggering device **30** sends a signal that allows for turning on to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**.

(28) The power electronic switch software control circuit **60** then sends a turning on command to the power electronic switch drive circuit **70**, and the power electronic switch drive circuit **70** drives the power electronic switch **10** to turn on the power electronic switch **10** after receiving the turning on command.

(29) Thus, the sequential action device for the mechanical switch **20** and the power electronic switch **10** according to the first embodiment of the present utility model may sequentially actuate the turning on of the power electronic switch **10** and the closing of the mechanical switch **20** during a power-on of the main circuit, that is, first close the mechanical switch **20**, and then turn on the power electronic switch **10**.

(30) During the power-off of the main circuit, the power electronic switch **10** according to the first embodiment of the present utility model is turned off from the initial turning off state, the mechanical switch **20** according to the first embodiment of the present utility model is opened from the initial closing state where the power electronic switch **10** is first turned off, and then the mechanical switch **20** is opened.

(31) During the power-off of the main circuit, the mechanical operating mechanism **40** unidirectionally changes from the first position to the second position and then to the third position.

(32) During the power-off of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the first position, both the mechanical switch **20** and the triggering device **30** are in the closed state.

(33) During the power-off of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the second position, the mechanical operating mechanism **40** opens only the triggering device **30**. At this time, the mechanical switch **20** remains closed.

(34) Once the triggering device **30** is in the opened state, it sends a signal that allows for turning off to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**, and the power electronic switch software control circuit **60** then sends a turning off command to the power electronic switch drive circuit **70**. The power electronic switch drive circuit **70** drives the power electronic switch **10** to turn off the power electronic switch **10** after receiving the turning off command.

(35) During the power-off of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the third position, the triggering device **30** remains in the opened state based on the third position. The mechanical switch **20** begins to open based on the third position. At this time, the power electronic switch **10** is turned off long before the mechanical switch **20** begins to open.

(36) In addition, when the detection circuit **50** detects that the mechanical switch **20** is opened, the detection circuit **50** sends a signal that allows for turning off to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**.

(37) This ensures that the power electronic switch **10** is turned off before the opening of the mechanical switch **20**.

(38) Thus, the sequential action device for the mechanical switch **20** and the power electronic switch **10** according to the first embodiment of the present utility model may sequentially actuate the turning off of the power electronic switch **10** and the opening of the mechanical switch **20** during a power-off of the main circuit, that is, first turn off the power electronic switch **10**, and then open the mechanical switch **20**.

(39) FIG. 2 shows a schematic diagram of a sequential action device for a power electronic switch and a mechanical switch according to a second embodiment of the present utility model.

(40) FIG. 2 and FIG. 1 are substantially the same, except that in FIG. 2, an output of the triggering device **30** acts both on the power electronic switch drive circuit **70** and the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**, respectively, while in FIG. 1, an output of the triggering device **30** only

acts on the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**.

(41) As the triggering device **30** of FIG. 2 may actuate the power electronic switch drive circuit **70** and the power electronic switch software control circuit **60** respectively, the power electronic switch **10** may be turned off/turned on more reliably.

(42) In FIG. 2, the triggering device **30** may be embodied by a micro switch, a grating sensor, a Hall sensor or another sensor. The triggering device **30** is in the opened/closed state based on sensing of a position of the mechanical operating mechanism **40** by a sensor. The triggering device **30** may be considered to act as a switching signal, which on the one hand is connected in series within the drive circuit **70** of the power electronic switch **10**. If the switching signal is not in the closed state, the drive circuit **70** of the power electronic switch **10** may not be turned on, and therefore cannot drive the power electronic switch **10**. When the triggering device **30** is in the closed state, it turns on the drive circuit **70** of the power electronic switch **10**. When the triggering device **30** is in the opened state, it turns off the drive circuit **70** of the power electronic switch **10**. On the other hand, as described in FIG. 1, the triggering device **30** sends a signal that allows for turning off/turning on to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**.

(43) According to the second embodiment of the present utility model, during the power-on of the main circuit, the power electronic switch **10** turns on from an initial turned off state, the mechanical switch **20** closes from an initial opened state, where the mechanical switch **20** is closed first, and then the power electronic switch **10** is turned on.

(44) During the power-on of the main circuit, the mechanical operating mechanism **40** unidirectionally changes from the third position to the second position and then to the first position.

(45) During the power-on of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the third position, both the triggering device **30** and the mechanical switch **20** are in an opened state. As the triggering device **30** is opened, the power electronic switch drive circuit **70** of the power electronic switch **10** turns off, which further turns off the power electronic switch **10**. At this time, both the power electronic switch **10** is in a turned off state and the mechanical switch **20** is in an opened state.

(46) Meanwhile, as the triggering device **30** is opened, the triggering device **30** sends a signal that allows for turning off to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**, and the power electronic switch software control circuit **60** sends a turning off command.

(47) Meanwhile, the detection circuit **50** detects that the mechanical switch **20** is opened, and the detection circuit **50** sends a signal that allows for turning off to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**. The power electronic switch software control circuit **60** sends a turning off command to the power electronic switch drive circuit **70**.

(48) During the power-on of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the second position, the power electronic switch **10** remains in the turned off state, and the mechanical operating mechanism **40** opens the triggering device **30** and closes the mechanical switch **20**.

(49) During the power-on of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the first position, the mechanical switch **20** is already closed, and the triggering device **30** is changed into the closed state based on the first position. In other words, the mechanical switch **20** is closed before the triggering device **30** is closed.

(50) At this time, the triggering device **30** is in the closed state, which further turns on the drive circuit **70** of the power electronic switch **10**.

(51) Meanwhile, as the triggering device **30** is closed, the triggering device **30** sends a signal that allows for turning on to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**, and the power electronic switch software control circuit **60** sends a turning on command.

(52) In addition, when the detection circuit **50** detects that the mechanical switch **20** is closed, the detection circuit **50** sends a signal that allows for turning on to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**.

(53) The power electronic switch software control circuit **60** then sends a turning on command to the power electronic switch drive circuit **70** that has been turning on, and the power electronic switch drive circuit **70** drives the power electronic switch **10** to turn on the power electronic switch **10** after receiving the turning on command.

(54) Thus, the sequential action device for the mechanical switch **20** and the power electronic switch **10** according to the second embodiment of the present utility model may sequentially actuate the turning on of the power electronic switch **10** and the closing of the mechanical switch **20** during the power-on of the main circuit, that is, first close the mechanical switch **20**, and then turn on the power electronic switch **10**.

(55) During the power-off of the main circuit, the power electronic switch **10** according to the second embodiment of the present utility model is turned off from the initial turning on state, the mechanical switch **20** according to the second embodiment of the present utility model is opened from the initial closing state, where the power electronic switch **10** is first turned off, and then the mechanical switch **20** is opened.

(56) During the power-off of the main circuit, the mechanical operating mechanism **40** unidirectionally changes from the first position to the second position and then to the third position.

(57) During the power-off of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the first position, both the mechanical switch **20** and the triggering device **30** are in the closed state.

(58) During the power-off of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the second position, the mechanical operating mechanism **40** opens only the triggering device **30**. At this time, the mechanical switch **20** remains closed.

(59) Once the triggering device **30** is in the opened state, it turns off the drive circuit **70** of the power electronic switch **10**. This further turns off the power electronic switch **10**.

(60) Meanwhile, once the triggering device **30** is opened, it sends a signal that allows for turning off to the power electronic switch software control circuit **60**, and the power electronic switch software control circuit **60** further sends a turning off command to turning off the power electronic switch **10**.

(61) This ensures that the power electronic switch **10** is turned off before the opening of the mechanical switch **20**.

(62) During the power-off of the main circuit, when the mechanical operating mechanism **40** is in the third position, the triggering device **30** remains in the opened state based on the third position. The mechanical switch **20** begins to open based on the third position. At this time, the power electronic switch **10** is turned off long before the mechanical switch **20** begins to open.

(63) Thus, the sequential action device for the mechanical switch **20** and the power electronic switch **10** according to the second embodiment of the present utility model may sequentially actuate the turning off of the power electronic switch **10** and the opening of the mechanical switch **20** during a power-off of the main circuit, that is, first turn off the power electronic switch **10**, and then open the mechanical switch **20**.

(64) Through a sequential control logic that sequentially interlocks a mechanical switch and a power electronic switch, the sequential action device for a mechanical switch and a power electronic switch according to the present utility model is able to ensure that the power electronic switch is turned on only after the mechanical switch is closed, and is turned off before the mechanical switch is opened. In this way, the arc discharge of the mechanical switch may be avoided, improving the service life and reliability of the mechanical switch, and enhancing safety.

(65) The block diagrams of circuits, instruments, devices, apparatuses, and systems involved in the present utility model are only used as exemplary examples and are not intended to require or imply that they must be connected, arranged, and configured in the manner shown in the block diagrams. As it may be appreciated by those skilled in the art, these circuits, instruments, devices, apparatuses, and systems may be connected, arranged, and configured in any manner, as long as the desired purpose can be achieved.

(66) Those skilled in the art may understand that the above embodiments are only exemplary and not limiting, and embodiments of the present utility model may be modified, combined, partially combined and replaced according to design requirements and other factors, as long as they fall within the scope of the appended claims or their equivalent, that is, within the patentable scope claimed by the present utility model.

Claims

1. A sequential action device for a power electronic switch and a mechanical switch connected in series in a main circuit, comprising: a mechanical operating mechanism, wherein the mechanical switch is opened/closed based on a position of the mechanical operating mechanism; a power electronic switch software control circuit and a power electronic switch drive circuit that control the power electronic switch to turn on/turn off, where the power electronic switch software control circuit controls the power electronic switch drive circuit to control the power electronic switch to turn on/turn off; a triggering device that based on a position of the mechanical operating mechanism, sending a signal that allows for turning on/turning off to the power electronic switch software control circuit to control an action of the power electronic switch drive circuit; a detection circuit that detects whether the mechanical switch is closed, wherein when the detection circuit detects that the mechanical switch is closed, the detection circuit sends a signal that allows for turning on to the power electronic switch software control circuit, wherein during a power-on of the main circuit, the turning on of the power electronic switch and the closing of the mechanical switch are sequentially acted, and during a power-off of the main circuit, the turning off of the power electronic switch and the opening of the mechanical switch are sequentially acted.
 2. The sequential action device according to claim 1, wherein: the triggering device further controls the turning on/turning off of the power electronic switch drive circuit.
 3. The sequential action device according to claim 1, wherein: the sequential action during the power-on of the main circuit means that the mechanical switch is closed first, and then the power electronic switch is turned on; the sequential action during the power-off of the main circuit means that the power electronic switch is turned off first, and then the mechanical switch is opened.
 4. The sequential action device according to claim 1, wherein: the triggering device is embodied by one of a micro switch, a grating sensor, and a Hall sensor.
 5. The sequential action device according to claim 1, wherein: during a power-on, the mechanical switch is in an opened state and the triggering device is in a turned off state, based on a third position of the mechanical operating mechanism; the mechanical switch closes based on a second position of the mechanical operating mechanism, and the triggering device is in the turned off state based on the second position of the mechanical operating mechanism; the mechanical switch is in a closed state and the triggering device is in a turned on state, based on a first position of the mechanical operating mechanism.
 6. The sequential action device according to claim 1, wherein: during a power-off, the mechanical switch is in a closed state and the triggering device is in a turned on state based on a first position of the mechanical operating mechanism; the mechanical switch remains in a closed state based on a second position of the mechanical operating mechanism, and the triggering device is in a turned off state based on the second position of the mechanical operating mechanism; the mechanical switch begins to open based on a third position of the mechanical operating mechanism, and the triggering device is in the turned off state based on the third position of the mechanical operating mechanism.
 7. A solid-state starter comprising the sequential action device according to claim 1.
 8. A solid-state circuit breaker comprising the sequential action device according to claim 1.
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